

Your best-ranking asset for your own head term is a stranger's Reddit comment.

A live Google result for *healthcare payroll software*, pulled 14 September 2026 at 16:44 UTC, United States. This is the page a payroll director sees before a rep ever gets the call.

#4

REDDIT, RECOMMENDING EMPEON

"Look at Empeon. That's all they do." Not on empeon.com.

0

EMPEON.COM IN TOP 9

Paylocity, Netchex and ADP hold the first three.

3 : 0

AI OVERVIEW CITATIONS, NETCHEX : EMPEON

Google's AI answer names five vendors. Empeon is not one.

LIVE ORGANIC RESULT, 14 SEP 2026

#	DOMAIN	WHAT RANKS
1	paylocity.com	Healthcare industry page
2	netchex.com	Healthcare payroll page
3	adp.com	Healthcare payroll article
4	reddit.com	r/Payroll thread recommending Empeon
5	celeryway.com	"Top 6" listicle, 23 Aug 2026
6	onpay.com	Doctors and healthcare page
7	axiomhrs.com	Healthcare HCM page
8	apspayroll.com	Healthcare industry page
9	medesk.net	"6 Best" listicle, 31 May 2026
— empeon.com Absent from page one		

Source: live SERP observation, United States, English. No paid results and no local pack on this query. Features present: AI Overview, People Also Ask, related searches.

WHAT GOOGLE'S AI OVERVIEW TELLS THE SAME BUYER

VENDOR NAMED	POSITIONED AS
ADP Workforce Now	Large, multi-state systems
UKG Ready / Pro	24/7 shift complexity
Netchex	"Best overall" for credential tracking
Gusto	Small single-site clinics
Paycor	Earned wage access

Cited sources in the answer: netchex.com (3), celeryway.com (2), youtube.com (2), gusto.com, adp.com, apspayroll.com, outsourceaccelerator.com (1 each). empeon.com: 0. The answer's feature list names PBJ by name.

NETCHEX IS NOT ONE LIST. IT IS A FRANCHISE.

Netchex publishes 2026 "5 best payroll software" lists for skilled nursing, healthcare, assisted living, hospitals and health systems, and hospice. Each ranks Netchex first. Third parties (mesh.ai, folio3, wesuggestsoftware) publish their own. A buyer researching any Empeon vertical meets a shortlist Empeon did not write and is not on.

The specialist is moving.

Viventium added scheduling and time & attendance on 2 September 2026, after acquiring Apploi, "available immediately for skilled nursing and senior living." That is the cluster the audit parked in wave two. It is now a displacement conversation for your reps, not a content plan.

Read this the right way.

Demand for exactly what Empeon sells exists and is being answered every day by three larger vendors, two listicles, and one anonymous Reddit user. The homepage already says PBJ and HPPD. The problem is not the product truth. It is that nobody finds it at the moment they are looking.

Four things sales can hold me to, and the definition I would sign first.

Nothing on this page needs media spend. Each item is a field, a page, a clock, or a proof asset that a rep can use the week it ships.

1. THE MARKETING-SOURCED DEFINITION, DRAFTED FOR SIGNATURE IN WEEK ONE

TERM	DEFINITION	HUBSPOT FIELD	OWNER
First touch	First recorded session source on the contact	Original source, drill-down 1 and 2	Marketing
Lead creation source	Channel that created the contact record	Lead source, required on create	Marketing
Assist	Named marketing touch inside 30 days before deal creation	Marketing assist, multi-select, dated	Marketing
Opportunity source	Who created the deal and from what	Deal source, required, no blank allowed	Sales
Revenue source	Opportunity source of a closed-won deal, locked at close	Deal source at close, read-only	Sales ops

Rule: a deal is **marketing-sourced** only when lead creation source and opportunity source agree; everything else is assisted or partner-sourced and reported that way. At Align, \$1.91M of open pipeline carried no source at all, more than the entire website column. That is a field design problem; this table is the fix.

2. A SPEED-TO-LEAD SLA WITH A CLOCK AND AN OWNER

- Qualified form (named buyer, in-scope vertical) → owner auto-assigned inside 5 minutes.
- First human touch inside 1 business hour, logged in HubSpot as a call, email, or meeting.
- Unworked after 4 business hours → escalates to the VP of Sales.
- Two numbers on the sales dashboard every Monday: hours to first touch; qualified-form-to-meeting rate.

Why it is first: at Align, 7 of 22 qualified buyer leads were hot and never followed up, including a Chief People Officer who arrived from ChatGPT with an immediate need. Cheapest revenue on the board.

3. FOUR PAGES THAT ARE ALSO FOUR REP LANDING PAGES

PAGE (TITLE TO SHIP)	US VOL.	REP USE
Healthcare payroll software Empeon	320	Head-term door
Home care payroll software Empeon	260	Home care outbound
PBJ reporting software Empeon	50	SNF compliance hook
Skilled nursing payroll software Empeon	10	The Netchex list query

Semrush US volumes observed 30 Aug 2026. Low volume on a bottom-funnel term is a feature: these are typed by people with budget. Each page carries one next step, not five.

4. TWO PROOF ASSETS REPS ARE MISSING

THIS WEEK

The iQIES hook. QIES retires tomorrow, 15 September 2026; FQ4 PBJ filings have been iQIES-only since 17 August. A one-page "what changes in iQIES and how Empeon files it" piece is an outbound reason to call that expires in weeks. It goes to AEs before it goes on the blog.

The reporting answer. Captterra rates Empeon 4.8 of 5 across 46 reviews; the one recurring complaint is report customisation and implementation time, while Netchex sells "98% support satisfaction." A short, honest reporting-and-implementation proof page, with a named operator quote, closes the objection reps hear most on review sites.

THE THREE NUMBERS I WOULD SHARE WITH SALES

NUMBER	WHY SALES CARES
Marketing-sourced pipeline, \$ and count	One definition, one report, no argument
Hours to first touch on qualified forms	The SLA, kept or missed, by owner
Qualified-form-to-meeting rate	Whether inbound is worth a rep's hour

What I am not claiming. No causation for the \$2.19M of supported pipeline. No revenue forecast for Empeon. No rank beyond the one live result on page A. Company names appear only where a deal record already carries them.